Cambridge O Level English Language (1123) - Syllabus Breakdown (2024-2026)

Paper 1: Reading (2 Hours, 50 Marks)

This paper focuses primarily on **Reading (80%)**, with **Writing (20%)** integrated into summary tasks. It consists of two sections:

Section A: Comprehension and Use of Language (25 Marks)

- **Text A:** A **900-word narrative** from 21st-century literature.
- **Question 1 (16 Marks):** Short-answer questions assessing your understanding of both **explicit** and **implicit** meanings.
- **Question 2 (9 Marks):** Language analysis questions that explore the **writer's techniques** and their effects on the reader.

Section B: Summary and Short Response (25 Marks)

- **Text B:** A **600-word** passage.
- **Question 3a: Summary (20 Marks):** Write a **150-word summary** demonstrating your ability to extract key points, organize ideas, and use precise vocabulary.
- **Question 3b: Short Response (5 Marks):** Answer a question assessing your understanding of **implicit meanings and attitudes** within the text.

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Paper 2: Writing (2 Hours, 50 Marks)

This paper focuses **heavily on writing (80%)**, with some reading skills (20%) assessed in **Section A**.

Section A: Directed Writing (25 Marks)

- You will analyze **one or two texts (**400–450 words**)** and write a **speech, email, report, letter, or article** (250–350 words).

- **Marks Breakdown:**
  - **15 Marks (Writing):** Evaluates your ability to structure ideas, use a wide range of vocabulary, maintain the correct tone, and ensure grammatical accuracy.
  - **10 Marks (Reading):** Assesses how well you extract and integrate relevant ideas from the given texts.

Section B: Composition (25 Marks)

- Choose **one question** from:
  - **Two descriptive prompts**
  - **Two narrative prompts**
- Write a **350-450 word** piece that demonstrates **clear structure, vivid language, strong expression, and grammatical accuracy**.

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